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Page 1 — Cover

Japan 7-Day Golden Route Planner

Tokyo → Hakone → Kyoto → Osaka — the classic one-week first-timer route.

A planning tool, not a guarantee. Routes, hours, and prices change — always check current-year updates.

Page 2 — How the Golden Route Works (Read First)

The Golden Route links Japan's most famous first-trip stops in a logical west-bound line, so you rarely backtrack.

- The flow: Start in Tokyo (big city + day trips), pause in Hakone (mountains, hot springs, views), move to Kyoto (temples, tradition), and finish in or near Osaka (food, nightlife, airport access).
- One direction. Travelling roughly Tokyo → Osaka means you keep moving forward and pack/unpack fewer times.
- Base smart. You don't need a hotel in every town — many travelers base in Kyoto and day-trip nearby.
- Reserve key transport early. Long-distance trains and popular stays fill up; book ahead and confirm current fares.
- Pace it. Seven days is enough to enjoy the highlights, not to see everything — choose depth over a checklist.

> Tip: keep one lighter "buffer/rest" half-day so the week doesn't burn you out.

Page 3 — 7-Day Skeleton (Customize Freely)

A starting framework. Move things around to fit your interests and arrival time.

Day	Base / area	Focus	Notes
1	Tokyo	Arrive, settle, easy first evening	Adjust for jet lag
2	Tokyo	City highlights	Pick 2-3 areas, not all
3	Tokyo → Hakone	Travel + onsen/views	Pack a small overnight bag
4	Hakone → Kyoto	Travel + first Kyoto sights	Forward main luggage if possible
5	Kyoto	Temples & traditional districts	Start early to beat crowds
6	Kyoto → Osaka (day or base)	Osaka food & city	Easy day trip from Kyoto
7	Osaka / departure	Last bites, depart	Confirm airport transfer time

My adjustments: _____

Page 4 — Day-by-Day Itinerary (with Transit Column)

Copy this page for each day. Use the transit column for train/connection details so nothing slips.

Time	Plan	Transit / connection	Notes
Morning			
Midday			
Afternoon			
Evening			

- First train/connection time today: _____
- Reservation needed? ☒ Confirmed? ☒
- Notes: _____

Page 5 — Transit-Day Checklist

For the days you change cities (Days 3, 4, 6/7). Confirm times the day before.

- ☒ Departure time & platform/station checked (check latest)
- ☒ Seat reserved (if required) / pass valid for this route
- ☒ Checkout time vs train time leaves buffer
- ☒ Luggage plan: carry / forward (see next page)
- ☒ Next accommodation address & check-in time saved
- ☒ Snacks / water for the journey
- ☒ Phone charged + offline map saved
- Notes: _____

Page 6 — Luggage Forwarding Reminder

On a multi-city week, sending your big bag ahead can make travel days much easier.

- Idea: Forward your main suitcase from one accommodation to the next and travel with a small overnight bag.
- Plan ahead: Arrange forwarding the day before; delivery often takes a day or more — confirm timing locally.
- Overnight bag must-haves: change of clothes, toiletries, chargers, medications, valuables.
- My forwarding plan:
- From: _____ → To: _____ Send by: _____
- Notes: _____

Page 7 — City Highlights Shortlist

List your top picks per city. Choose a focused few rather than everything.

City	Top picks	Booking needed?
Tokyo		☒
Hakone		☒
Kyoto		☒
Osaka		☒

If short on time, I'll skip: _____

Page 8 — Food Wish List

The Golden Route is a food trip too — Osaka especially. Note must-tries and any dietary needs.

City	Want to eat	Reservation?
Tokyo		☒
Hakone		☒
Kyoto		☒
Osaka		☒

Allergies / must-avoid: _____

Page 9 — Packing Checklist

One week, multiple cities — pack light enough to move easily.

Essentials

- ☒ Passport & travel documents
- ☒ Payment cards + some cash
- ☒ Phone, charger, power bank, adapter
- ☒ Transport pass / tickets info
- ☒ Small overnight bag (for transit days)

Clothing & comfort

- ☒ Comfortable walking shoes
- ☒ Weather-appropriate layers
- ☒ Compact umbrella / rain layer
- ☒ Reusable water bottle

Health & misc

- ☒ Medications & basics

- ☒ Toiletries (travel size)
- ☒ Day bag for sightseeing
- Notes: _____

Page 10 — Budget Jotter

Rough estimates only; confirm current prices.

Category	Planned	Actual
Inter-city transport		
Local transport		
Accommodation		
Food		
Attractions / activities		
Luggage forwarding		
Other		
Total		

Page 11 — Pre-Trip Final Check

- ☒ Skeleton customized to my interests
- ☒ Inter-city transport reserved — confirm latest fares & times
- ☒ All accommodations booked, addresses saved
- ☒ One buffer/rest half-day kept
- ☒ Luggage forwarding plan decided
- ☒ Offline maps & key info saved on phone
- Final notes: _____

End of planner. Enjoy the Golden Route at your own pace. Always verify current-year routes, hours, and prices before you go.